PARTICIPANT HANDOUT · FOUR SESSIONS

Busy for God, or with Him?

Your notes for each session and the Return log for the weeks in between.

> “Remain in me, as I also remain in you. No branch can bear fruit by itself; it must remain in the vine. Neither can you bear fruit unless you remain in me. I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing.”
>
> John 15:4–5 (NIV)

Two operating systems. “I’m doing things for God” begins with effort. “I’m becoming with God” begins with attachment.

The Return

Abiding isn’t passive. It’s returning your heart’s attention to Jesus, again and again:

- **When you’re distracted,** return.
- **When you’re anxious,** return.
- **When you succeed,** return.
- **When you’re discouraged,** return.
- **When you fail,** return.

Session 1: The Activity vs. the Abiding

JOHN 15:1–8

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Read this out loud: Abiding isn't passive. It's returning, again and again, all day long.

1. Which operating system have you been running on lately? How can you tell?
2. Where in your day is it hardest to "return"? What pulls you away?
3. What would change this week if you measured your days by nearness to Jesus instead of productivity?

My notes

This week: The Return: five times a day, when you notice your attention has drifted, stop and say, "Jesus, I'm back." Mark it on the Return log.

Before there is fruit, there is attachment.

Session 2: The Service vs. the Surrender

LUKE 10:38–42 · ROMANS 12:1–2

Read this out loud: When a man truly walks with God, service becomes the overflow, not the substitute.

1. Are you more like Martha or Mary right now? Be honest.
2. Where do you serve partly because you're seen, thanked or needed?
3. What would surrender look like before you serve this week?

My notes

This week: Before you serve anywhere this week, take five quiet minutes with Jesus first. Write down one thing you heard or noticed.

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Serving is supposed to be the overflow of walking with God, not a substitute for it.

Session 3: The Ministry vs. the Master

REVELATION 2:1–5 · MATTHEW 7:21–23

Read this out loud: The greatest threat to intimacy with Jesus isn't always sin. Sometimes it's being so busy for Him that you stop being with Him.

1. What "good thing" in your spiritual life is most at risk of replacing the best thing?
2. If Jesus wrote a letter to you like the one to Ephesus, what would He praise? What would He hold against you?
3. What did your "first love" for Jesus look like? What would it take to return to it?

My notes

This week: Read Revelation 2:4–5 each morning. Then do one thing you did when your love for Jesus was new.

Kingdom work is never meant to replace Kingdom relationship.

Session 4: The Fruit vs. the Effort

JOHN 15:5, 8, 16 · GALATIANS 5:22–23

Read this out loud: Fruit isn't primarily activity. It's Christ's character becoming visible in you.

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1. Which fruit of the Spirit is most visible in you right now? Which is hardest to see?
2. Where have you been trying to produce fruit by effort instead of abiding?
3. Who is one person God may want your fruit to feed this season?

My notes

This week: Ask two people who know you well, “Where do you see Christ in me?” Write down what they say. Then plant one seed: share what God has been teaching you with one other man.

Formation was never the finish line. God forms men to send them.

The Return log

Each day, tally how many times you noticed you’d drifted and returned to Jesus. Write one thing you noticed.

Day	Times I returned	What pulled me away	What I noticed
Day 1			
Day 2			
Day 3			
Day 4			
Day 5			
Day 6			

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Day	Times I returned	What pulled me away	What I noticed
Day 7			

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